



# SUJET STATAPP 329 - 2026-2027

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**Organisme :** CREST

**Catégorie :** Sociologie Quantitative

**Sujet :**

**Working Around the Clock? Trends in Evening, Night, and Weekend Work in Europe. Analysis of the European Union Labor Force Survey**

## Description du sujet :

Over two decades ago, Presser (2003) argued that American work had moved toward a "24/7 economy," with a growing share of employees working evenings, nights, or weekends instead of the standard nine-to-five workweek. Whether Europe has followed the same path is contested. Cross-national evidence for 2005 to 2015 finds substantial and persistent differences in nonstandard-schedule work by education, gender, and parental status across European countries (Gracia, Han, and Li 2021), and more recent French evidence finds that exposure to nonstandard schedules is not spreading evenly: it has fallen among highly qualified workers while rising sharply among low-skilled women, particularly weekend work (Lambert and Langlois 2022).

This StatApp asks: How has exposure to evening, night, and weekend work changed across Europe, and is it becoming more concentrated among less-educated and lower-status workers? We will use the European Union Labor Force Survey (EU-LFS), whose core annual questionnaire has, since the late 1990s, asked employed respondents whether they usually work evenings, nights, Saturdays, Sundays, or in shifts.

We will test whether change in exposure to nonstandard schedules reflects individual-level factors?education, sector, occupation, and parental status?as well as country-level factors such as working-time regime (Anttila et al. 2015). Random-effects models will describe cross-national variation in nonstandard-schedule work and its country-level correlates; fixed-effects models, exploiting the repeated cross-sections, will isolate within-country change net of time-constant country characteristics.

Statistical software will be Stata or R, depending on the students' preferences.

At the end of this project, students will have:

- An excellent understanding of random- and fixed-effects models for repeated cross-sectional, cross-national survey data
- An excellent understanding of the EU Labor Force Survey, the largest European household sample survey, collected by the EU statistical office Eurostat, and a premier source of information both for EU public policy and academic research
- With effort, perseverance, and a bit of luck, the chance to publish an article in an international peer-reviewed journal

## Données du sujet :

The EU Labour Force Survey (EU-LFS) is organized by the EU statistical office Eurostat and is the largest European household sample survey. Its core annual questionnaire includes variables on whether an employed respondent usually works evenings (EVENWK), nights (NIGHTWK), Saturdays (SATWK), Sundays (SUNWK), in shifts (SHIFTWK), or from home (HOMEWORK) in their main job, collected every year (with country coverage expanding over time) rather than only in occasional ad hoc modules. Microdata are available from the 1990s into the present, for up to 35 European countries. More information about the European Union Labor Force Survey can be found on the Eurostat website:

<https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/web/microdata/european-union-labour-force-survey>

**Modèles envisagés du sujet :**

Random-effects (multilevel) models, with individuals nested in country-years nested in countries, to describe cross-national and over-time variation in exposure to nonstandard work schedules and to test country-level predictors such as working-time regime. Fixed-effects models exploiting the repeated cross-sections across years to control for unobserved, time-constant country characteristics and isolate within-country change. Statistical software: Stata or R, depending on student preference.

**Bibliographie du sujet :**

Gracia, Pablo, Wen-Jui Han, and Jianghong Li. 2021. "Nonstandard Work Schedules in 29 European Countries, 2005-15: Differences by Education, Gender, and Parental Status." *Monthly Labor Review*. doi: 10.21916/mlr.2021.17. This article provides the closest existing cross-national evidence on trends in nonstandard-schedule work in Europe by education, gender, and parental status, motivating this StatApp's extension to the longer, annual EU-LFS series.

Anttila, Timo, Tomi Oinas, Mia Tammelin, and Jouko Nätti. 2015. "Working-Time Regimes and Work-Life Balance in Europe." *European Sociological Review* 31(6):713-724. doi: 10.1093/esr/jcv070. This article clusters European countries into distinct working-time regimes that differ sharply in exposure to unsocial hours, motivating this StatApp's country-level focus.

Lambert, Anne, and Loup Langlois. 2022. "Non-Standard Work Schedules: Increasing Exposure among Low-Skilled Women." *Population & Societies* 599. doi: 10.34847/nkl.efafyj01. This article finds that recent trends in nonstandard-schedule work in France have polarized by education and gender, with especially sharp increases among low-skilled women.

Presser, Harriet B. 2003. *Working in a 24/7 Economy: Challenges for American Families*. New York: Russell Sage Foundation. This book introduced the "24/7 economy" framing that motivates this StatApp, though based only on U.S. data.

**Notation du sujet :**

**Commentaires :**